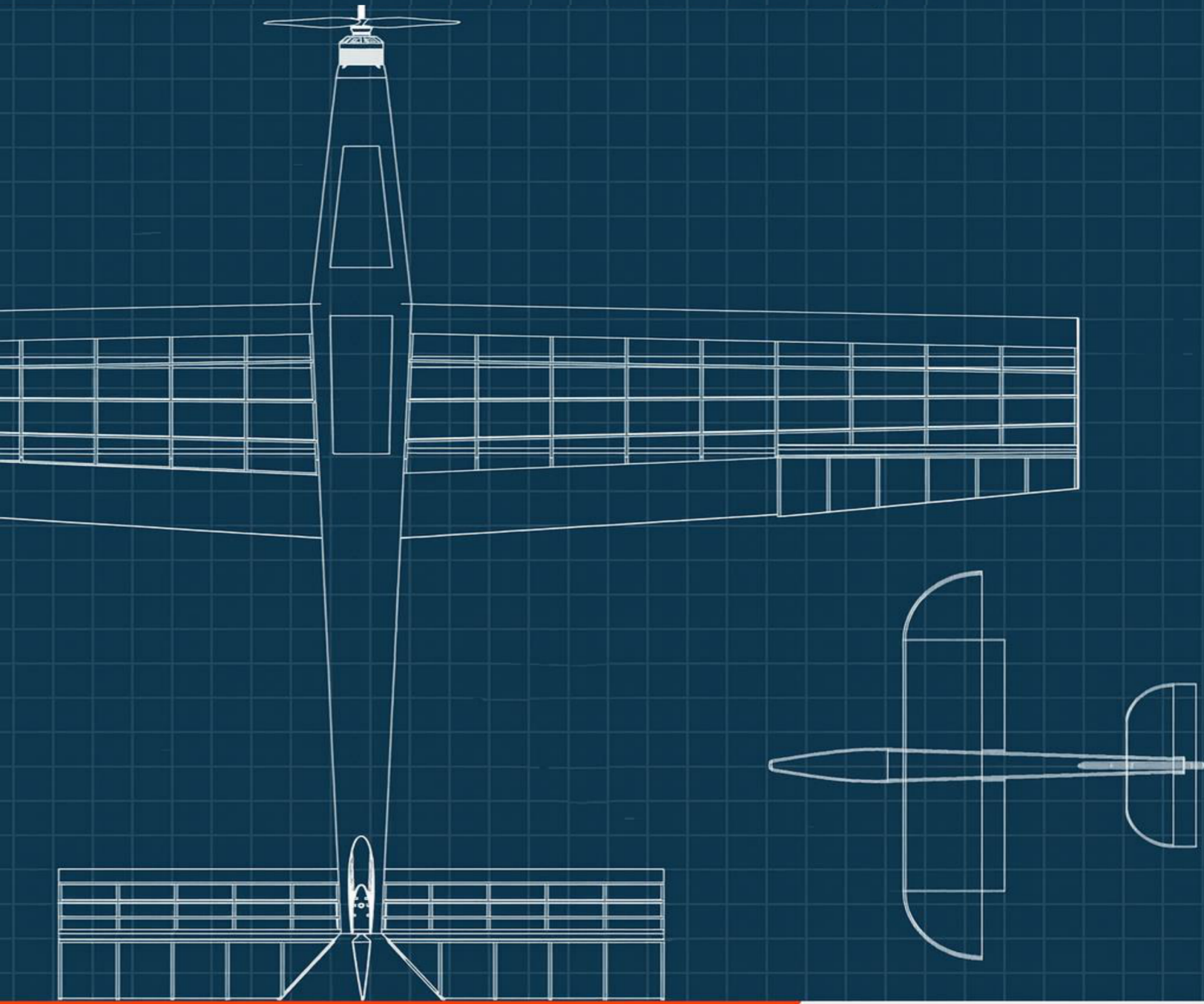


DESIGN BUILD FLY



2026-2027
**SPONSORSHIP
PACKET**

UF | UNIVERSITY of
FLORIDA

Letter from the Team

University of Florida
Design/Build/Fly

Dear Prospective Sponsor,

Design/Build/Fly at the University of Florida, or simply UF DBF, is a student-led team that designs, manufactures, and flight-tests a from-scratch RC aircraft each academic year for the AIAA DBF competition. Your support directly funds materials, avionics, test equipment, and travel, turning classroom theory into hands-on engineering and real flight data.

We partner closely with sponsors through recruiting events, design reviews, and mentorship. In return, we highlight your brand on our aircraft, team apparel, and social channels. Thank you for considering a partnership that develops talent and advances student aerospace development.

Sincerely,



James Greek
President/Project Manager



Bobby Welch
Chief Design Engineer

Sponsor Impact

Your partnership helps students move from classroom analysis to flight-ready hardware through design reviews, manufacturing, test planning, and competition execution.

100+

Universities compete annually at the international AIAA DBF flyoff.



About UF Design/Build/Fly

UF DBF is a student-led engineering team within AIAA at the University of Florida that designs, builds, and flies a clean-sheet RC aircraft each season for the AIAA DBF competition. The team gives students a complete, hands-on aerospace design environment where classroom theory is translated into a mission-ready aircraft.

About 50 active members run the full concept-to-flight cycle: requirements, trade studies, subsystem design, prototyping, manufacturing, flight test, and mission rehearsals. The team is organized into Aerodynamics, Systems, and Structures so members can specialize in a technical area while still understanding the full aircraft development process.

Students use SolidWorks for parametric CAD and assemblies, ANSYS Mechanical and Fluent for FEA/CFD, and MATLAB and XFLR5 for performance modeling, sizing, airfoil selection, wing design, and empennage analysis. These tools help the team connect analysis decisions directly to build quality, flight testing, and competition performance.

During manufacturing, students gain practical experience with composites such as carbon fiber, wood built-up structures, heat-shrinking materials, CNC machining, laser cutting, and other production methods used to turn analysis into flight-ready hardware. Recent competition results include 33rd of 112 teams in 2024–2025 and 8th of 99 teams in 2022–2023.



About UF DBF

During the 2025–2026 season, UF DBF also expanded work on a quad-copter blended wing-body eVTOL concept to learn advanced negative molding methods and develop a more robust avionics package. This effort gives students another opportunity to investigate aircraft configuration, manufacturing repeatability, and integrated systems design.

DBF's mission is to give UF students a rigorous, collaborative, competition-focused environment to develop practical engineering and teamwork skills while applying classroom concepts to a mission-ready aircraft. Members learn to document design decisions, present trade studies, build test articles, analyze flight-test data, and improve designs through iteration.

Sponsorship directly funds materials, equipment, test articles, avionics, and competition travel. In return, partners receive brand placement on our aircraft and media, a motivated recruiting pipeline, and opportunities to mentor design reviews and shop builds throughout the season.

Your support helps us iterate faster, test deeper, and deliver a reliable aircraft on flight day. More importantly, it helps graduate students who have worked through real engineering constraints, communicated across disciplines, manufactured hardware, and arrived in industry ready to contribute on day one.

For sponsors, UF DBF offers more than a logo placement. It is a direct connection to students who have proven they can work on schedules, meet safety and testing requirements, solve technical problems, and carry a complex aerospace project from concept to competition.

**Student-built aircraft. Sponsor-supported engineering.
Industry-ready graduates.**



Why Sponsor UF DBF?

Partnering with UF DBF gives your organization brand visibility, direct recruiting access, and a measurable impact on STEM education while helping a top student team deliver safe, well-engineered aircraft under real constraints.

Business Promotion

- High-visibility placement on aircraft livery, pit banners, team apparel, and the team website.
- Season-long exposure across social media and campus events; brand presence at the international AIAA DBF flyoff where 100+ universities compete annually.
- Attribution in progress updates, recap posts, and the year-end impact report so your support is clearly credited.

Student Education

- Your support unlocks advanced materials, electronics, and processes that mirror industry practice composites, CNC, additive, and avionics integration.
- Funding accelerates prototyping cycles and testing, improving airworthiness, mission performance, and engineering rigor.
- Students graduate with deeper hands-on experience, design reviews, documentation discipline, and flight-test data analysis.

Recruiting & Talent Pipeline

- Direct access to a vetted pool of multidisciplinary engineers who have shipped hardware and met strict safety/test criteria.
- Sponsor-only touchpoints such as resume books, tech talks, and interview days to efficiently identify candidates.
- Positive brand affinity with students who build with your support are more likely to choose your organization.

Build with us. Recruit from us. Help us fly farther.

UF Design/Build/Fly | 2026–2027 Sponsorship Package



Sponsorship Levels & Benefits

Tier	Contribution	Benefits
Diamond	\$5,000+	• Largest logo on aircraft (10"+), pit banner, shirts, and website. • Recruiting events and resume book access. • Host a design review or facility tour. • Dedicated social posts and year-end impact report.
Blue	\$2,500–\$4,999	• Large logo on aircraft (7"-9"), pit banner, shirts, and website. • Recruiting event and resume book access. • Dedicated social posts and year-end report.
Orange	\$1,000–\$2,499	• Medium logo on aircraft (4"-6"), pit banner, shirts, and website. • Dedicated social post and recap mentions. • Thank-you photo from the team.
Gold	\$500–\$999	• Small logo on pit banner (1"-4"), shirts, and website. • Social media thank-you.
Silver	\$250–\$499	• Logo on website and shirts. • Social media thank-you.
Bronze	<\$250	• Name listed on website and season recap email.

Add-Ons (any tier): Co-branded workshop • Prototype/subsystem naming • Team apparel • Custom recruiting events



Sponsorships directly support materials, avionics, test articles, equipment, and competition travel.

Every contribution helps students design, manufacture, test, and compete with a reliable mission-ready aircraft.



How to Donate?

Option A — Online (Fastest and Preferred):

1. Email ufl.aiaa.dbf@gmail.com with the intended amount to be donated.
2. Open the MAE Student Groups giving page: [Click Here](#)
3. Scroll to Design, Build, Fly and click or scan our QR code.



1. Enter your gift amount and complete the checkout.

IMPORTANT NOTE: In the Comments box, paste this line so your gift is routed to our team: Please direct 100% of this gift to the UF AIAA Design, Build, Fly (UF DBF) student group.

Option B — Email us for help:

Write to ufl.aiaa.dbf@gmail.com with your preferred donation method and amount.

Contact Us:



@gatorsdbf



[linkedin.com/company/ufdbf](https://www.linkedin.com/company/ufdbf)

Thank you for supporting UF DBF!